PREPRINT · PLAIN-ENGLISH GUIDE

Stratified Source Realism — A Plain-English Guide

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1 The big question

If you could describe *everything that exists*, from the chemistry of a cell to the shape of spacetime to mathematics itself, what kind of description would it be? Would it be one long list, a heap of separate worlds, or something with an internal structure?

Philosophers have offered several answers. David Lewis argued that every possible world is as real as ours. The set theorist Joel David Hamkins has argued that there are many equally legitimate mathematical universes. Stratified Source Realism (SSR) offers a third kind of picture: reality as a **layered structure that builds itself up under rules and limits**, and stops at the point where the rules have nothing more to add.

2 The idea in one paragraph

SSR starts from a well-known result in mathematics, the **Knaster–Tarski theorem**. It says that if you have a well-behaved space of possibilities (a "complete lattice") and a rule that only ever adds and never takes away (a "monotone operator"), then there is a *smallest* collection that the rule leaves unchanged: its **least fixed point**. SSR's proposal is to model the totality of reality, which it calls the Omniverse O, as exactly that least fixed point. The rule is a generative operator, Γ_C, filtered by constraints C that say what is admissible. In symbols:

$$O = \mu\Gamma_C \quad \text{with} \quad \Gamma_C(O) = O$$

The result is organised into nine **strata** (layers), linked by maps that preserve structure. Timelines are treated as systems of states with approximate ("ε-tolerant") recurrence. What counts as *actual* is relative to a level, with a rule that keeps the levels consistent with one another.

3 An everyday analogy for the least fixed point

ANALOGY ONLY, NOT PART OF THE THEORY

"Where can I get to by train?" Suppose you want the complete list of stations you can reach from your home station.

1. Start with your home station. That is the seed.
2. Apply the rule: add every station one direct journey away from anything already on the list.
3. Apply a constraint: only count lines that are actually running (the "filter").
4. Repeat. The list only ever grows.
5. **Stop when a full pass adds nothing new.** The list is now complete, and it is the *smallest* list that contains your station and is closed under "one more journey".

That final, stable list is a least fixed point. Running the rule once more changes nothing. SSR uses the same pattern, but for "everything admissible" instead of railway stations.

Where the analogy breaks down: a railway is finite and you can check it. SSR's lattice is abstract, and the claim that its fixed point *is* reality is a philosophical thesis, not something a timetable could confirm.

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4 The nine strata at a glance

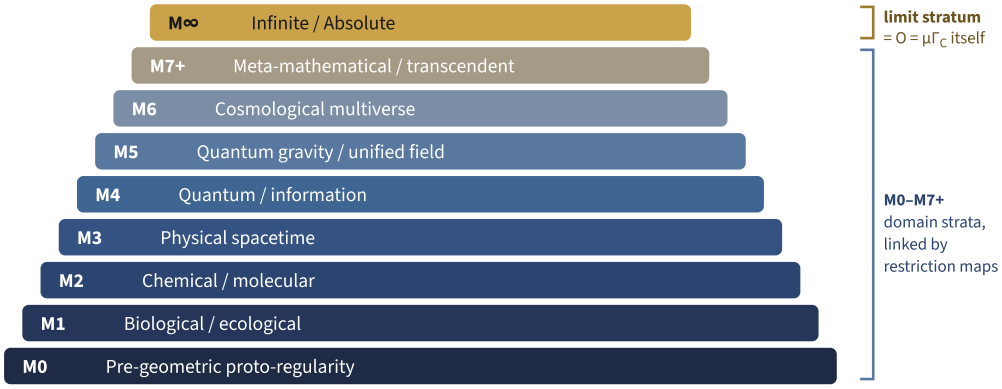


Figure 1. The nine strata of SSR, shown as stacked layers in the order of their indices (M0 at the base). Labels for M0–M7+ come from the Public Edition §3. M∞ was added in v4.2 of the model as the *limit stratum*, where the build-up is complete and which is identified with $O = \mu\Gamma_C$ itself. It is named after infinity, but the count is nine. Schematic only; the narrowing is decorative, not a measurement.

5 What SSR claims, and what it doesn't

What it does

- Uses an **established theorem** (Knaster–Tarski): under its stated assumptions, a least fixed point exists.
- Puts forward a **metaphysical thesis**: that this least fixed point can serve as a model of total reality.
- Gives a **structured vocabulary** for strata, restriction maps, timelines, recurrence and level-relative actuality.
- Compares itself with Lewis's modal realism and Hamkins's multiverse, and accepts the burden of showing that it explains more.
- Comes with an **open-source finite model** that you can run and inspect.

What it doesn't

- It makes **no empirical or physical claims** and no testable predictions.
- It is **not a validated physical theory**, and the theorem does not show that reality *is* the fixed point. That identification is the thesis.
- The Chronological Realignment Array is **conceptual systems design**, not a working device, and makes no claim of time displacement.
- The software **illustrates** the framework; it does not validate it.
- It is a **preprint** and has not been peer-reviewed.

6 Try the interactive model

LIVE IN YOUR BROWSER

The **SSR–CRA reference model** at luxthorley.github.io/luxthorley runs a small, finite version of the lattice. It applies the operator Γ_C step by step, starting from the empty set and stopping at the least fixed point, and passes through all nine strata. It keeps an audit log and has a 3D strata visualiser. The source code (v4.2) is at github.com/LuxThorley/luxthorley. In effect it is the railway analogy, except that the trains are on time.

Companion pieces deposited with the preprint: the *Chronological Realignment Array* (CRA) model and the *SSR and OmniGenesis Integration*. Both are supplementary, conceptual and software material. The OmniGenesis project site is www.omnigenesis.linkpc.net.

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7 How to cite

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8 Credits and AI acknowledgement

Oliver Lux Prime Thorley is the sole author and originator of Stratified Source Realism, and is responsible for all claims, selections and errors.

AI acknowledgement (equal credit): Grok (xAI), ChatGPT (OpenAI) and Microsoft Copilot are credited equally for the shared findings developed in dialogue with the author, including the originating SSR essay and the SSR–OmniGenesis concept mapping. Grok Bot assisted with editing and code. In line with COPE guidance, no AI system is listed as an author. Naming these tools is an acknowledgement, not an endorsement by xAI, OpenAI or Microsoft.

9 Links

Preprint (Zenodo)	https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23439073
PhilSci-Archive	Under moderation at PhilSci-Archive (no public link yet)
Interactive model	https://luxthorley.github.io/luxthorley/
Source code	https://github.com/LuxThorley/luxthorley
OmniGenesis site	https://www.omnigenesis.linkpc.net (supplementary)
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IN SHORT

SSR is a philosophical framework. It takes a solid piece of mathematics and proposes a bold but clearly labelled interpretation of it. Read it, run the model and argue with it; that is what preprints are for.

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